

he Merchant of Venice - Act One and Two Class Test

(Write your name on the last p.

Section One - Short Questions (50%)

1. Who wrote The Merchant of Venice? William Shakespeare ✓ 2
2. In what year was The Merchant of Venice first published? 1604 ✗ 1600
3. Who does Bassanio ask for a loan in Act One Scene One? Antonio ✓ 2
4. Why does Bassanio want to borrow money? To impress Portia ✓ 2
5. How much does Shylock loan Bassanio? 3000 ducats ✓ 2
6. What religion is Shylock? Jewish Shylock is Jewish ✓ 2
7. What deal do Shylock and Antonio make? The deal that Shylock and Antonio make is that if Antonio cannot pay back the money within three months, Shylock gets to take a pound of his flesh ✓ 2
8. Where does Portia live? Portia lives in Belmont ✓ 2
9. How will Portia's husband be decided? Portia's husband will be decided by a lottery. If the suitor picks the right casket out of the three (gold, silver and lead), he gets to marry Portia. Otherwise, he must leave, tell no one what he chose and never marry again. ✓ 2
10. Who is Jessica's father? Shylock is Jessica's father ✓ 2
11. What is the name of Shylock's clown who leaves him for Bassanio? Lancelot ✓ 2
12. Give two reasons why Shylock hates Antonio. Shylock hates Antonio because he is a Christian and because Antonio harasses Shylock because he is a Jew ✓ 4
13. Who does Jessica run away with? Jessica runs away with her lover ✓ 2
14. Who chooses the gold casket? The Prince of Morocco chooses the gold casket ✓ 2
15. What is inside the gold casket? A skull and a note that says "All that glisters is not gold" ✓ 2
16. Who chooses the silver casket? The Prince of Arragon chooses the silver casket ✓ 2
17. What is inside the silver casket? A note and a picture of a fool ✓ 2
18. Why is the masquerade party cancelled? The masquerade party is cancelled because there is a storm and Bassanio needs to leave for Belmont immediately ✓ 3
19. What do you call it when someone discriminates against Jewish people? Antisemitism ✓ 2
20. State three themes of The Merchant of Venice: Racism, love money and appearance ✓ 3

48/50

Spelt work,
well done!

Two - Key Quotes (30%)

Finish the following quotes

1. In sooth, I know not why I am so sad. It wearies me. ✓ 2
2. Try what my credit can in Venice do. ✓ 2
3. The Jew is the very devil incarnation. ✓ 2
4. Though I am daughter to his blood, I am not to his manner. ✓ 2
5. Let the forfeit be nominated for an equal pound of your fair flesh. ✓ 2

(10)

B - Caskets

1. What is the inscription on the gold casket? "Who chooseth me shall gain what many men desire". ✓ 3
2. What is the inscription on the silver casket? "Who chooseth me shall get ^{as much as} what he deserves". ✓ 2
3. What is the inscription on the lead casket? "Who chooseth me must give up hazard all he hath". ✓ 2
4. What message is left inside the gold casket? "All that glitters is not gold". ✓ 3

(10)

C. Character Quotes

1. State one quote by Shylock: "I hate him for he is a Christian". ✓ 3
2. State one quote by Antonio: "In sooth, I know not why I am so sad. It wears me". ✓ 3
3. State one quote by Bassanio: "In Belmont is a lady richly left". ✓ 3
4. State one quote by Portia: "I may neither choose who I would nor refuse who I ~~do~~ dislike". ✓ 3

32/34

Excellent!

(12)

Section Three (20%) - Please use PIE for your answers!

Can you provide one example of dramatic irony in *The Merchant of Venice*. How does the use of dramatic irony add the audience's enjoyment of the play?

One example of dramatic irony in *The Merchant of Venice* is when Bassanio is talking about how much he loves Portia. "In Belmont is a lady richly left" is when Bassanio is talking about her but he doesn't know that Portia and Nerissa are talking about him in Belmont. Because Portia is quite xenophobic and racist, she only wants to marry someone from near where she lives, and Nerissa mentions Bassanio. The use of dramatic irony adds to the audience's enjoyment of the play by creating suspense. The audience knows they both want each other, but will have to wait for them to realise it.

Excellent answer!

Do you believe Shylock is an evil character? Explain your answer.

I don't believe Shylock is an evil character. Instead I believe he's been abused so much over years that he has become angry with the world. "You call me misbeliever, cut-throat dog and spit upon my Jewish gaberdine" is when Shylock is telling Antonio how much Antonio has abused him, but Antonio says he will do so again. This shows that Shylock has been hated by Christians, especially Antonio, for many years and that they don't care about him. After all this abuse, it would make sense that he would become cold and bitter.

Try to include the quote more naturally - "Shylock describes how Antonio called him a 'misbeliever, cut-throat dog and spit upon my Jewish gaberdine'". It flows much better than just starting a sentence with a quote.

Do you believe that Bassanio truly loves Portia? Explain your answer.

I don't believe that Bassanio truly loves Portia because I think he just wants her money.

he talks about Portia, he says "I, Belmont
lady richly left ~~as~~ he then goes on to talk
how beautiful she is, but the first thing
said about her was her money. ^E To me, this
shows that even if he shows some affection
towards her, the driving factor is money. ^E Also,
the fact that he feels he needs money to impress
her says to me that he doesn't think his love is
~~as~~ strong enough to win her over and instead he
needs money to do so.

19

Great answer

Extra Writing

$$\frac{99}{105}$$

=

94%

This is a superb result and reflects the work
you've been putting in all year. ~~!!!~~ To improve
even further, practice incorporating your quotes more
naturally into your answers. Try not to just state
a quote and then "Antonio said this to show..."
Excellent work Oisín, well done!

10/10/25

Oisín Argand

What grade are you hoping for?

85%